

Homer Quan - Tech Lead and Visionary Crafting Tomorrow's AI products

CONTACT INFORMATION

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HIGHLIGHTS

With over 15 years in the tech industry, holding pivotal roles at Yahoo and experience with early-stage startups, notably as a Techstars alumni now in its C-round, I've founded two startups. The most recent one is Pajama Cats Media, where we harness AI to revolutionize children's literacy. Armed with expertise in NLP, cloud solutions, and a deep understanding of customer and market dynamics, I am well-positioned to guide a company from conception to the launch of a commercially-ready AI product.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Pajama Cats Media Inc, New York, NY

Co-founder and CEO

Feb 2022 – present

- Product Development:
 - * Partnered with Carnegie Mellon University researchers, streamlining the prototype that originally took months to create a single book. Through my contributions, I refined the process to transform a PDF into the interactive experience in under 5 minutes.
 - * Pioneered the integration of GPT in our storytelling tool, envisioning and executing a technological leap in our released product.
 - * Led product development and launched multiple apps, including a flagship book marketplace on the Apple App Store.
- Customer development:
 - * Secured a strategic partnership with a prominent charter school in DC as our pilot customer.
 - * Adapting features through data-driven insights from educators, parents, and kids, culminating in our inaugural sales contract.
 - * Delivered tailored presentation and demos at events like Collision and webinars, boosting App Store impressions 10x and driving user adoption.
- Growth & Funding:
 - * Engaged VC and angel investors with pitches and a comprehensive data room, successfully obtaining our initial external funding.
 - * Reassessed and refined our growth strategy, such as transitioning to selling books as standalone apps and generating early revenue through public domain book titles.

Reflen Inc, Hanover, NH

Co-founder

April 2014 – Dec 2020

- Spearheaded the creation and deployment of a proprietary data-driven AI system, designed to elevate job performance in real-time without disrupting existing software infrastructure.
- Successfully integrated chatbots focused on enhancing employee engagement within leading digital platforms such as Workday and Salesforce.
- Led the engineering team to successfully deliver the MVP and secured a coveted spot in the NH accelerator program.

Wise Systems Inc, Boston, MA

Chief Architect

March 2015 – Nov 2015

- Developed the back-end for the initial functional MVP for this MIT spin-off startup, which subsequently gained entry to Techstars and secured early-stage investment.
- Established engineering procedures and led a team of 2 PhD researchers and 3 engineers, fostering a high-performing, collaborative environment through guidance and strategic hiring.

Yahoo!, Sunnyvale, California USA

Software Engineer

June 2011 – Dec 2013

- Yahoo Search: Collaborated with a select 5-member special task team on the rapid prototype of Graph Entity Search, a natural language engine echoing Siri's conversational expertise.
- Yahoo News: Optimized Yahoo News' performance across frontend, content delivery, and data storage. Implemented a content injection pipeline using Apache Spark for daily local news. Collaborated on software to cluster semantic topics, enhancing NLP models with the research team.
- Yahoo Shopping and Local: Developed software for Yahoo local and shopping, leveraging web performance.

Google Inc, Mountain View, California USA

Software Engineer Intern in the Platform Team

June 2010 – September 2010

- Designed a tool for Google's hardware engineers to streamline data center operations by simplifying component compatibility checks.

CONSULTANT AND
MENTOR
EXPERIENCE

Lunar Aspect,

AI Consultant

May 2024 – Dec 2024

- Architecture and implement workflow automation using meta generation, task planning, and GraphRAG for deep document understanding.

MassChallenge,

Judge for Early Stage Venture

2023, 2024

- Evaluated and mentored early-stage ventures, providing critical feedback and support to foster growth and innovation.

EDUCATION

Temple University, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania USA

M.Sc (PhD incomplete) in Computer Science **September 2009 – June 2011**

The University of Manchester, Manchester, UK

M.Sc in Computer Science **September 2004 – August 2006**

Wuhan University, Wuhan, Hubei P.R.China

B.S. in Computer Engineering **September 2000 – June 2004**

CERTIFICATION

Foundations of Venture Capital **Jan 2023**

- Columbia University Business School Executive Education [\[link\]](#)

HIGHLIGHTED SKILLS

- **AI:** Proven track record in developing advanced AI systems with a strong focus on large language models and reinforcement learning to drive breakthrough innovations.
- **Knowledge and Graph:** Expertise in creating and managing knowledge-driven solutions, including complex graph data analytics and intelligent inference systems that deliver actionable insights.
- **Real-Time Data:** Skilled in architecting scalable real-time data processing solutions using platforms like Spark and Flink, ensuring robust performance and rapid insights.
- **Mobile & Cloud Softwares:** Extensive experience in developing mobile applications and cloud-based solutions, leveraging containerization and microservices for seamless deployment and scalability.
- **Product Strategy & Team Leadership:** Demonstrated success in guiding product strategy from concept through execution, effectively leading cross-functional teams to achieve impactful business outcomes.

PUBLICATIONS

- **Book Chapter:** Online Social Network Chapter, Pervasive Communications Handbook, CRC Press, 2011. [Link](#)
- **A Connectivity-Based Popularity Prediction Approach for Social Networks**, Proceedings of IEEE International Conference on Communications (ICC), 2012. [Link](#)
- **Analyzing the Visual Complexity of Web Pages Using Document Structure**, Behavior and IT, 2013. [Link](#)